

Beyond The *mic*

INDIA'S BIGGEST
PODCASTERS SHARE
THEIR WISDOM AND
LEARNINGS



Everyone wants to start a podcast. Almost nobody is still making one in year three.

That gap is what this cover story is about. Raj Shamani recorded his first 50 episodes into a phone's voice memo app with a blanket over his head, for an audience of about 50: roughly 25 of whom were him, replaying his own show. Soha Ali Khan recorded 30 episodes with her own money before she let a single brand near them. Nikhil Taneja visited 150 campuses before he switched

on a mic, and still makes only eight episodes a year. Mae Mariyam Thomas, at this since 2015, offers the least romantic advice of the lot: studio rates, budget lines, and a two-year test before you judge anything. And Dhruvank Vaidya, who runs music and podcasts at Spotify India, explains why the money hasn't caught up to the audience yet.

They contradict each other, on video, on preparation, on whether the numbers mean anything at all. And that's the useful part. 